4-day workweek in 21st century

Nowadays, more and more people are striving for a " Work-life balance". There are companies and organizations that implement a 4-day workweek to provide a more flexible working schedule, which has various effects on different aspects.





The ILO Hours of Work (Industry) Convention (No. 1) of 1919 introduced a maximum standard working time of 48 hours per week and 8 hours per day as an international norm.

International Lahour Organization(1919)

Overworked may cause:

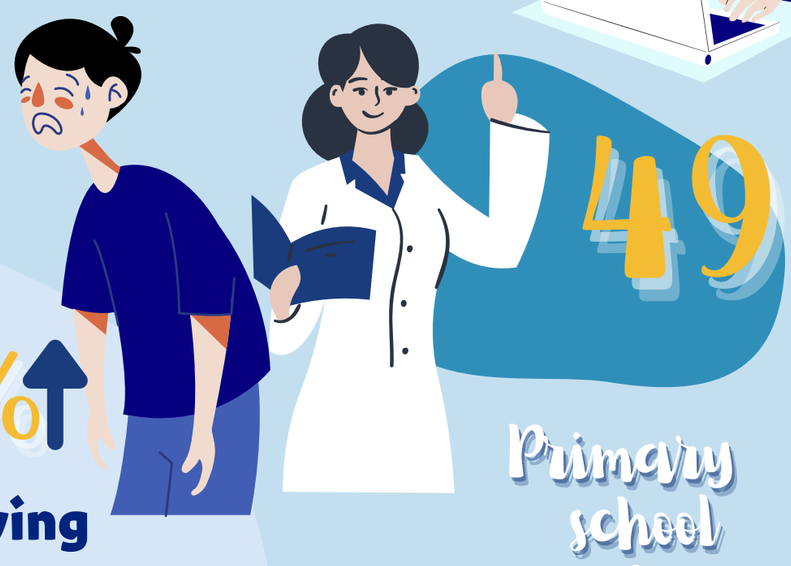
1.Physical issue

60%↑ 35%↑ 17%↑

Risk of heart-related problems (European Society of Cardiology, 2010)

Risk of stoke (World Health Organization, 2021)

Risk of dying from heart disease (World Health Organization, 2021)



2.Mental Issue

According to Heckman (2022), overworked may cause :

- **Depression and anxiety**
- **Tension headaches and migraines**
- **Worsened sleep**
- **Bad habits like substance and alcohol abuse**





3.Effectiveness

Crunch Mode: Programming to the Extreme - The Relationship Between Hours Worked and Productivity(n.d.) explain overworked employees are less productive than employees working an normal working week.

Average weekly working hour in different professionals

(in Hong Kong)(UBS,2018)



50 Call center agents



56 female sales assistant

49 Primary school teacher



48 Cooks

According to Barnes & Jones (2020), 4-day workweek based on the principle of the

100:80:100 model

Employees will receive 100% pay for 80% of their time and commitment to maintaining 100% productivity.



The change of working hour

Late 18th century
14–18 hrs
per day
in UK
(Zhao, 2014)

1833
15 hrs
per day
in UK
(Foster, 2022)

1864
10 hrs
per day
in UK
(Zhao, 2014)

1919
8 hrs or 48 hrs
per day per week
(International Labour Organization,1919)

1935
8 and 40 hrs
per day per week
5 day work week
(International Labour Organization, 1935)

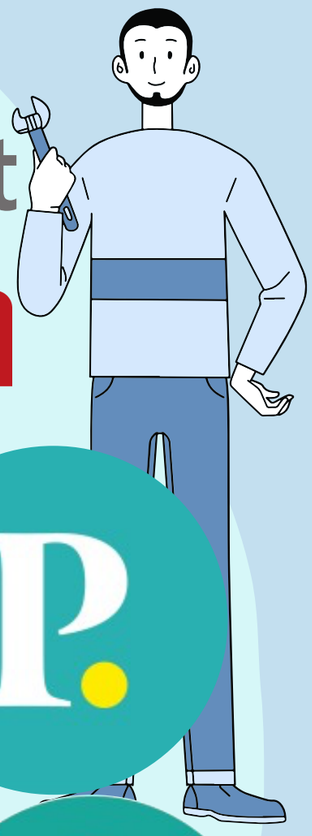
1962
$ + fewer
original
(International Labour Organization, 1962)

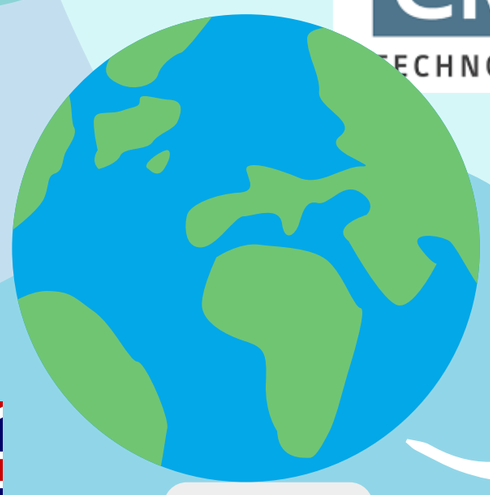
Persent
Average
40 hrs
in the world
(Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development, 2015)

Microsoft

Canon

CMG TECHNOLOGIES





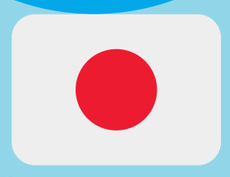
some companies in



Iceland
(Haraldsson & Kellam, 2021)



United Kingdom
(Join the UK 4 Day Week Pilot Programme, n.d.)



Japan
(Microsoft, 2019)

Working hours steadily declined from the 18th century to the 19th century. Until the 21st century, it keeps around 40 hours.

Shift to 4-day workweek



Company Sucess

Microsoft

According to Microsoft (2019), Company started using four-day workweek as a trial in summer 2019



Reduce in electricity costs



Reduce the number of page printed



Increase sales per employee

Global Success

In research from Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (2015),The most productive countries in the world, including Norway, Denmark, and Germany, work around 27 which is similar to the number proposed for a 4-day workweek.

Feasibility

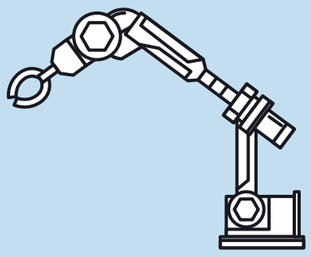


1. Employee support

According to JIL (2020), 74% of office professionals said they support a 4-day workweek.

2. Technology improvement



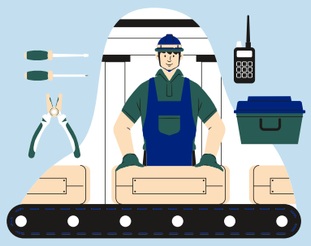


Employees can collaborate and communicate online and serve customers remotely

Accomplish the same amount of work in less time

Increase automation

3. Increase office work





In research from Haraldsson and Kellam (2021), 86% Iceland's workforce has moved to shorter hours for the same pay or will gain the right to do so, including preschools, offices, social service providers, and hospitals.

Job types



Office or technical jobs



Service industry, low skilled jobs,24/7 jobs

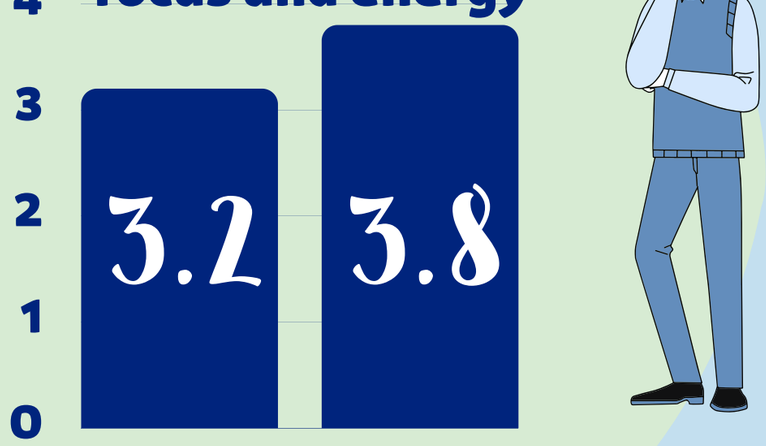
Influence

The 4-day workweek brings lots of impact to several aspects respectively.

Employee aspect

Increswe productivity

Average level of focus and energy



(Goff-Dupont, 2021)



Tired

Some companies compress hours and require employees to work 40 hours in 4 days.

Pressure

Productivity

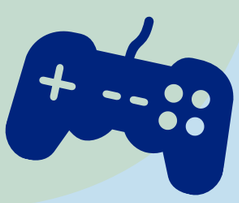


Increase spare time

2 days → 3 days

Work-life balance



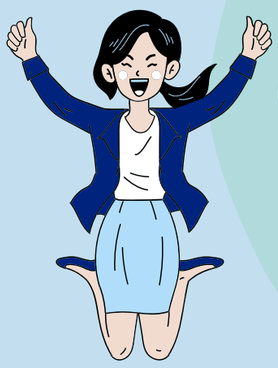


Health benefits

78%

Companies reported happier employees

(Henley Business School, 2019)



Companies found workers were less stressed

(CIPD, 2019)

70%

Company aspect



Reduced costs

Heating costs

Electricity costs

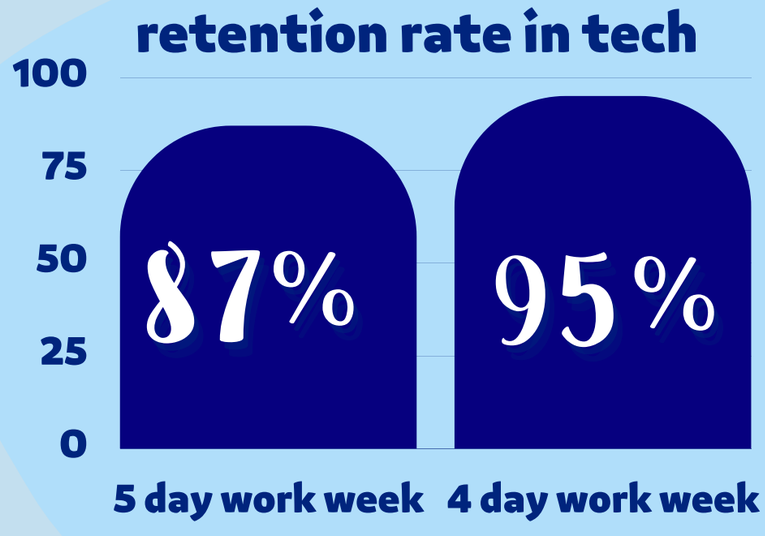
Potentially rental costs

Other costs e.g. free food & drinks, stationary

Increase sale

Improved staff retention

The average staff retention rate in tech



(Booz, 2018)



More job applications

4-day work week jobs get between 33 % - 70% more applications than those with a 5-day work week.



(Shetelboim, 2018)



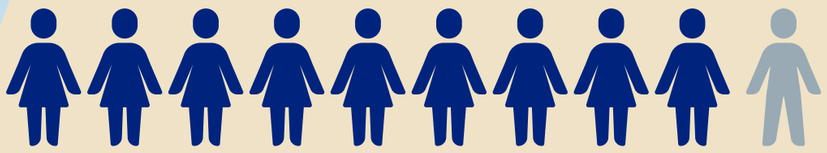
Society aspect

Gender Equality



2,000,000

British people are not currently in employment due to childcare responsibilities



89% are women



4-day workweek would be able employees to spend more time with their families and better juggle care and work commitments.



Gender-stress gap ↓



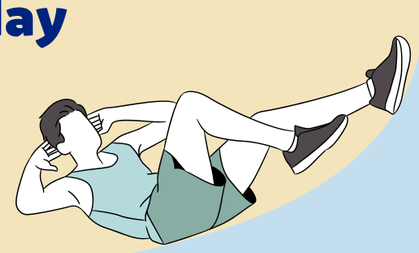
(The Young Women's Movement, n.d.)

Inefficient workforce

Some jobs take time to complete the tasks and some employees prefer the structure of a 5-day

↓

Productivity



Environment aspect

Reduce carbon footprint



Reduce carbon footprint by more than 30% due to

↓ **Commute**

↓ **Use of energy**

(Knight et al.,2012)



Alleviate global warming

Rosnick(2013) suggests worldwide change to fewer working hours could reduce future global warming by half by 2100 .



Accompanying measures

A 4-day workweek may lead to poor customer satisfaction. Companies may need to hire additional employees and use

rotating work weeks

but it may be difficult to manage and spend extra money



Will You Adopt 4-day workweek?

It's time for change!

Focus on how to work productively instead of working busily!

@Group4dayworkweek

Follow and support us !

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